MyProCoach™

TRAINING PLAN

Marathon Running

RUNNING	ADVANCED	8 WEEKS

Welcome

As an athlete and a parent I know how challenging it can be to train effectively for events like triathlons, marathons or cycling events. I have over 20 years of experience helping amateur athletes surpass their goals, while still making sure they have quality time available for family, friends and career.

To help you train effectively, I have decided to offer a subset of our extremely popular plans for free. Usually, our plans include email coach access, personal intensity zones and advanced tracking software. But these plans provide the basics for free to give you a taste.

It would mean the world to me if you tried a 1-month free trial of Unlimited Athlete, my low-cost coaching program, but for now, feel free to get used to my style of training. Please use and share this plan as much as you like.

FAQS

Who is the plan suitable for?

This short training plan is suitable for Advanced amateur runners, aiming to achieve peak Marathon fitness.

With just 8 weeks to go until event-day, this plan assumes you are currently able to run for up to 1hr 30mins. The plan builds up to race day, and helps improve your fitness and confidence.

People who follow a training plan have been shown to be twice as likely to succeed in reaching their goal.

How much training is involved?

Average weekly training hours are 6:22 with the biggest week at 8:11 hours. This includes 6 to 7 runs and a 45 minute strength and conditioning session.

There is usually 1 workout per day, with 1 day off each week. The fourth week is an active recovery week, with less training, to help your body recover and adapt.

How to get started

Do your best to follow the workouts below, ideally in their given order.

To help you train at the right levels, we use five training zones, based on feel or heart rate.

If you use heart rate, we have a calculator that can create your training zones:

www.myprocoach.net/hr-zones

TRAINING ZONES

	Intensity Description	% of Your Max Heart Rate
Z1	Easy (Recovery)	♥ 68-73%
Z2	Steady (Endurance)	♥ 73-80%
Z3	Moderately Hard (Tempo)	♥ 80-87%
Z4	Hard (Threshold)	♥ 87-93%
Z5	Very Hard (VO2 Max)	♥ 93-100%

GLOSSARY

Key	Description
Z1	Training Zone 1
Z2	Training Zone 2
Z3	Training Zone 3
Z4	Training Zone 4
Z5	Training Zone 5

Week 1

Peak Phase 1: 6 hrs 52 mins

Phil's tip

This plan includes a strength and conditioning workout each week.
Download your strength and conditioning PDF: https://bit.ly/RunSandC

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1	47 mins		1 hr 20 mins	1 hr	1 hr	30 mins	1 hr 30 mins
	Aerobic Speed	**Recovery Day**	**Aerobic Endurance**	**Aerobic Endurance**	**Aerobic Endurance**	**Aerobic Endurance**	**Aerobic Endurance**
	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Mod. Hard
	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 secs recoveries in Z1). Main Set: Two sets of: (9 x 40 secs in Z5, with 20 sec recoveries in Z1) + 4 mins recovery in Z1 after the first set. Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.	Allows for recovery whilst promoting adaptation to previous training stresses. Helps you get faster and keep injuries at bay.	All in low to mid Z2. These runs are to be done slowly. They will gradually build your endurance and increase your efficiency. If you do them faster, you'll increase your injury risk for no real benefit.	All in low to mid Z2. This run should feel easy and you should be able to hold a conversation. These runs gradually build your endurance and increase your efficiency.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	All in low to mid Z2.	With Race Pace Finish: Easy or steady run all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 15 minutes at low to mid Z3. This run will help you stay strong when the race feels the toughest. Doing this at the end of your long run in training will give you confidence to push for the finish on race day.
SESSION 2				45 mins			
				Strength and Conditioning			
				Adaptation Phase			
				Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips.			

Week 2

Peak Phase 1: 7 hrs 18 mins

Phil's tip

When you're exercising for longer than about 70-80 minutes you need to consume carbohydrate during your workouts to stop your energy levels from dropping.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		1 hr	58 mins	1 hr	1 hr 20 mins	30 mins	1 hr 45 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Speed	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Mod. Hard
		All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: Two sets of: (8 x 60 secs in Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1) + 4 mins recovery in Z1 after the first set. Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. If you prefer, split this workout as 50 mins in the morning and 30 mins in the afternoon or evening	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	With Race Pace Finish: Easy or steady run all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 15 minutes at low to mid Z3.
SESSION 2				45 mins			
				Strength and Conditioning			
				Adaptation Phase			
				Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.			

Week 3

Peak Phase 1: 7 hrs 38 mins

Phil's tip

During your Zone 2 workouts, you should theoretically feel able to chat throughout. If not, slow down.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		1 hr	53 mins	1 hr	1 hr 30 mins	30 mins	2 hrs
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Speed	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Mod. Hard
		All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: Two sets of: (5 x 80 secs in Z5 + 40 sec recoveries in Z1) + 3 mins recovery in Z1 after the first set. Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. If you prefer, split this workout as 60 mins in the morning and 30 mins in the afternoon or evening	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	With Race Pace Finish: Easy or steady run all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 15 minutes at low to mid Z3.
SESSION 2				45 mins			
				Strength and Conditioning			
				Endurance Phase			
				Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.			

Week 4

Active Recovery Week: 4 hrs 25 mins

Phil's tip

In my training plans, every 4th week is an active recovery week. This gives your body a chance to recover and adapt.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		45 mins	42 mins	45 mins	33 mins	40 mins	1 hr
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Tempo Run	Strength and Conditioning	Aerobic Speed	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	Hard/Threshold	Endurance Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance
	It's vital to make the most of this recovery week. You need to fully recover and start the next training phase feeling fresh and eager to train hard. There is enough training during the recovery week so that you won't lose fitness.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2 to Z3. Main Set: 2 x (10 mins in low Z4 + 2 min recovery in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 secs recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 9 x (40 secs in Z5 + 20 sec recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 5

Peak Phase 2: 7 hrs 55 mins

Phil's tip

Want rapid email access to your own coach? Why not try my low-cost coaching program for 1-month free?
https://bit.ly/MPConemonthfree

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		55 mins	1 hr 30 mins	1 hr	1 hr	30 mins	2 hrs 15 mins
	Recovery Day	Speed Run	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance
		V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Mod. Hard
		Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 10 x (60 secs in upper Z5 + 2 min recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. If you prefer, split this workout as 60 mins in the morning and 30 mins in the afternoon or evening.	All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	All in low to mid Z2.	With Race Pace Finish: Easy or steady run all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 15 mins at low to mid Z3.
SESSION 2				45 mins			
				Strength and Conditioning			
				Endurance Phase			
				Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.			

Week 6

Peak Phase 2: 8 hrs 11 mins

Phil's tip

Find out more about your running form in my article:
What is Proper Running Form? https://bit.ly/MPCRunForm

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		1 hr	1 hr 30 mins	1 hr	56 mins 30 secs	30 mins	2 hrs 30 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Speed Run	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Mod. Hard
		All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. If you prefer, split this workout as 60 mins in the morning and 30 mins in the afternoon or evening.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 7 x (90 secs in upper Z5 with 3 min recoveries in Z1 to Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Easy or steady run all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2				45 mins			
				Strength and Conditioning			
				Endurance Phase			
				Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.			

Week 7

Peak Phase 2: 6 hrs 19 mins

Phil's tip

Pacing is a key factor for success in racing.
How to Pace Your Marathon Race: https://bit.ly/PacingYourMarathon

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		35 mins	1 hr	49 mins	1 hr	40 mins	1 hr 30 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Speed Run	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance
		All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (2 mins in upper Z5 + 3 min recoveries in Z1 to Z2). Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	All in low to mid Z2.	
SESSION 2				45 mins			
				Strength and Conditioning			
				Strength Phase			
				Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.			

Week 8

Race Taper Week: 2 hrs 10 mins

Phil's tip

Good luck for your event! We'd love to hear about your training journey and race day experience, via our Instagram, Facebook or Reviews pages.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		35 mins	30 mins	30 mins	30 mins		Marathon
	Recovery Day	Taper Week Run	Taper Week Run	Taper Week Run	Taper Week Run	Recovery Day	Race Day
		Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Hard/Threshold		
	This week you will maintain your fitness and eliminate any traces of fatigue. It's a good time to double check your race day logistics and strategies. If your race is on Saturday, take Friday as a rest day.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2. Main Set: 3 x (60 secs in low Z4 + 2 mins in Z2). Warm Down. 6 mins in Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2. Main Set: 3 x (60 secs in low Z4 + 2 mins in Z2). Warm Down. 6 mins in Z2. If your race is on Saturday, take today as a rest day.		Good Luck!
SESSION 2							

Reviews

Perfect Plan!

Fantastic training plan from MyProCoach to lead to my first full-distance IRONMAN finish at Arizona in 2022. During the plan, I improved in all three disciplines and PR'd an IRONMAN 70.3 tuneup race by 11 min.

I'm an Unlimited Athlete and love having coach access & a premium membership with TrainingPeaks.

Josh Murphy
23 / 01 / 2023

It really works- trust the plan!

I exceeded my goal of not only finishing but well under my ideal goal. I 100% attribute this to Phil Mosley's 20-week 70.3 plan. I stuck to the plan and I'm beyond ecstatic to say I completed the IRONMAN 70.3 Puerto Rico!

The training truly changed my life and changed the way I think about things I'm able to do now.

I'm forever grateful.

Melissa Marston
21 / 03 / 2023

Love my Unlimited Athlete plan!

I've trained for two years with my Unlimited plan. The best part is that I can request my training plan at any moment!

I did IRONMAN Florida 70.3 last weekend, I'm feeling great and really happy with my result.

I totally recommend MyProCoach!

Ana Maria Pinzon Chatelain
16 / 12 / 2022

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1

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